



**LEEDS**  
INTERNATIONAL  
SCHOOL

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# COMPREHENSIVE COMMUNICATION POLICY

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*Effective communication for educational excellence*

|                       |                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Policy Title          | : Comprehensive Communication Policy                                                                                          |
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| To be implemented by  | : All the Branches, Academic and Non-Academic<br>Departments of LEEDS International School Network                            |
| Related Documents     | : Social Media Usage Policy<br><br>And<br><br>Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy<br><br>Crises Communication Guidelines |

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# 1. Introduction

LEEDS International School Network is committed to fostering clear, effective, and inclusive communication across all our branch schools in Sri Lanka. As a leading international School, we recognize that successful communication is fundamental to our mission of providing quality education and building a strong school community.

This comprehensive Communication Policy has been developed to establish standards, guidelines, and best practices for all communication activities within and outside the LEEDS International School Network. It aims to ensure that our communication is consistent, accurate, timely, and aligned with our core values and educational philosophy.

## 2. Purpose and Scope

### 2.1 Purpose

The purpose of this Communication Policy is to:

- i. Establish a framework for consistent and effective communication across all LEEDS International School network
- ii. Define standards for various communication channels and contexts
- iii. Clarify roles and responsibilities related to school communications
- iv. Ensure all communication reinforces the school's vision, mission, and values
- v. Promote transparency while respecting privacy and confidentiality
- vi. Provide guidelines for crisis communication and issue management
- vii. Support positive relationships with all stakeholders

### 2.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- i. All LEEDS International School staff, including teaching staff, operations staff, and support staff
- ii. All LEEDS branches across Sri Lanka
- iii. School Board of directors and Network Coordination and Leadership Team members
- iv. Parents community
- v. Students (where appropriate and as guided by staff)
- vi. Third-party service providers representing the school and all other stakeholders

The policy covers all forms of communication including:

- i. Online communication (WhatsApp, Telegram, emails, website, other social media)
- ii. Verbal communication (telephone calls, face-to-face interactions, meetings, presentations)

### 3. Core Communication Principles

All communication at LEEDS International School Network is guided by the following principles:

i. **Accuracy and Honesty**

We communicate truthfully and provide accurate information to all stakeholders. We acknowledge mistakes promptly and correct them transparently.

ii. **Clarity and Accessibility**

We use clear, concise language appropriate to our audience. We ensure our communications are accessible to all.

iii. **Consistency**

We maintain consistency in messaging, branding, and style across all channels and branches to reinforce our identity and avoid confusion.

iv. **Respect and Cultural Sensitivity**

We communicate with respect for cultural diversity, demonstrating sensitivity to the multicultural nature of our school community. We avoid language that could be perceived as discriminatory or offensive.

v. **Timeliness and Relevance**

We provide information when it is needed, ensuring all communications are current and relevant to the intended audience.

vi. **Inclusivity**

We strive to ensure our communications reach and are understood by all stakeholders, regardless of language proficiency, technological access, or other potential barriers.

vii. **Two-way Communication**

We value dialogue and provide appropriate channels for feedback, questions, and concerns from all stakeholders.

### 4. Online Communication

LEEDS International School Network utilizes various online platforms for efficient and effective communication among all stakeholders. This section outlines the guidelines for all digital communication channels used by the school.

## 4.1 Communication Platforms Overview

LEEDS International School primarily uses the following online communication platforms:

1. **WhatsApp** - Primary platform for internal staff communication
2. **Telegram** - Primary platform for school-parent communication
3. **Email** - For formal and official communications
4. **School Website** - Public information and official announcements
5. **Learning Management Systems (EduGenie and Microsoft Team)** - For academic communication and resources
6. **Other Social Media Platforms** - For broader community engagement and marketing

## 4.2-Tiered Communication Structure

LEEDS International School implements a 5-tier communication structure for WhatsApp and Telegram groups to ensure efficient information flow while maintaining appropriate boundaries and hierarchy. Each level serves a specific purpose and includes designated members:

### 4.2.1. Level 1: Executive Communication (L1)

- i. **Purpose:** Strategic communication between Board of Directors and Network Coordination and Leadership Team.
- ii. **Members:** Chairman and Board of Directors, Network Coordination and Leadership Team.
- iii. **Content:** Strategic decisions, policy matters, governance issues, high-level approvals
- iv. **Administration:** Group created and managed by designated Communication Administrator from Central Office
- v. **Frequency:** As needed, with response expected ASAP

### 4.2.2. Level 2: Management Coordination (L2)

- i. **Purpose:** Communication between Branch Management and Board of Directors and Network Coordination and Leadership Team.
- ii. **Members:** Board of Directors, Network Coordination and Leadership Team, School Principals, Deputy Principals, branch HMs etc.
- iii. **Content:** Operational decisions, Academic related observations and decision making, resource allocation, school-specific decisions.
- iv. **Administration:** Group created and managed by designated group administrator
- v. **Frequency:** Regular updates expected at least daily, with responses within 12 hours for urgent matters

### 4.2.3. Level 3: Branch Level Coordination (L3)

- i. **Purpose:** Communication between Branch School Management and Network Coordination and Leadership Team
- ii. **Members:** Branch principals, relevant Network Coordination and Leadership Team.
- iii. **Content:** Departmental updates, curriculum matters, academic planning, department-specific procedures
- iv. **Administration:** Groups created and managed by relevant Network Management administrator.
- v. **Frequency:** Regular updated daily

#### 4.2.4. Level 4: Network-wide Staff Communication (L4)

- i. **Purpose:** Communication between all branch school members and Network Coordination and Leadership Team
- ii. **Members:** All teaching and non-teaching staff, Network Coordination and Leadership Team
- iii. **Content:** Network-wide announcements, shared resources, professional development, general updates
- iv. **Administration:** Groups created and managed by designated Communication Officer
- v. **Frequency:** Regular scheduled updates, typically weekly

#### 4.2.5. Level 5: Community Communication (L5)

- i. **Purpose:** Communication between school and parent communities
- ii. **Members:** Relevant school staff and parents (grouped by grade/year level, branch, or special interest)
- iii. **Content:** Event announcements, reminders, general information sharing, parent queries
- iv. **Administration:** Groups created and managed by designated Network leadership Administrator.
- v. **Frequency:** Daily one way communication only.

### 4.3 Group Creation and Management Guidelines

- i. All official WhatsApp and Telegram groups must be created by authorized group administrators
- ii. **Group names must follow the format:**
  - a. **For L1, L2 & L3 Groups** = Group Level\_ school Name\_ Branch Name\_Group Name
  - b. **e.g.: L1\_LEIS\_NCL\_Key Administration**
  - c. **For L4 & L5 Groups** = Group Level\_ School Name\_Branch Name\_Grade & Class\_Academic Year
  - d. **e.g., L4\_LEIS\_PAN\_PR 5A\_2024/2025**
- iii. Group descriptions must clearly state the purpose, members, and communication expectations
- iv. Always use title case letters when naming of groups
- v. Member lists must be updated within 48 hours of any staff changes. HR department should inform the relevant group admin via a message about any staff changes.
- vi. All the group admins need to add appropriate display picture which describe the group purpose
- vii. Annual audit of all groups to be conducted by dedicated compliance team members time to time.

### 4.4 WhatsApp and Telegram Communication Guidelines

WhatsApp is the primary platform for internal communication among LEEDS staff members, while Telegram is the main **one-way** communication between parents and the school.

#### 4.4.1. Appropriate Content

- i. Messages should be relevant to the group's purpose and intended audience
- ii. School-related content only; personal messages should be sent privately
- iii. No sharing of confidential student information in any group
- iv. Official announcements should be clearly marked as such

- v. Use of approved templates for recurring communication types

#### **4.4.2. Communication Etiquette**

- i. Maintain professional language and tone at all times
- ii. Acknowledge receipt of important messages with appropriate responses **(except Telegram)**
- iii. Do not use voice messages in professional groups
- iv. Use status updates appropriately and professionally

#### **4.4.3. Media Sharing**

- i. Share only high-quality images and videos that reflect school standards
- ii. Ensure all shared media has proper permissions and rights clearance
- iii. No staff members are allowed to take pictures or videos of any school events and publish in their personal social media pages. They only can share the content which is shared in the official school social media pages.
- iv. Posting images or videos of children should comply with the school's child protection and safeguarding policy.
- v. All the social media page admins should obtain proper approvals for the contents, images and videos from the designated member from the Network Coordination and Leadership Team.
- vi. Compress files, when possible, to save data. (WinZip etc.)

#### **4.4.5. Security and Privacy**

- i. Enable two-factor authentication for all official accounts
- ii. Do not share access credentials with unauthorized personnel
- iii. Report any security concerns immediately to IT department
- iv. Exit from all school groups when leaving employment at LEEDS

### **4.5 Telegram Communication Guidelines with Parents**

Telegram is the primary platform for communication between LEEDS International School and parents.

#### **4.5.1. Content and Parent Engagement Guidelines**

- i. All official announcements to be vetted by relevant department head before posting
- ii. Use of pinned messages for important ongoing information
- iii. Regular scheduling of posts to avoid overwhelming parents
- iv. Dedicated channels for specific types of information (e.g., academics, extracurricular, administration)
- v. No discussion of individual student matters in group settings
- vi. Parent contact information to be verified and updated at the beginning of each academic year
- vii. Clear guidelines for parents to be shared upon joining any group
- viii. Always follow the correct messaging format provided in this Policy manual. **(Annexure 1)**
- ix. Clear protocols for parents to ask questions and receive responses (LEEDS Hotline and head office e-mail address)
- x. All parental communication should comply with the LEEDS Parental Communication Policy.
- xi. Parent orientation sessions on effective use of school communication channels

#### 4.5.2. Moderation Policies

- i. When the policies are created or revised it should be communicated to all the stake holders via appropriate channels.
- ii. Clear community guidelines pinned in each group
- iii. Defined roles for moderators and their responsibilities
- iv. Process for addressing inappropriate content or behavior
- v. Documentation of significant incidents or concerns

### 4.6 Email Communication Guidelines

Email remains an essential tool for formal communications at LEEDS International School.

#### 4.6.1. Official Email Usage

- i. All staff to use official, "**name@leeds.lk**" email addresses for school correspondences.
- ii. Email signatures to follow standardized format provided in this Policy (**Annexure 2**)
- iii. Regular email maintenance expected (folder organization, archiving)

#### 4.6.2. Email Content Standards

- i. Use clear subject lines that accurately reflect the content
- ii. Use professional language and formatting
- iii. Response time expectations: 48 hours for standard emails, 24 hours for high-priority
- iv. Use of appropriate copy (CC) and blind copy (BCC) functions
- v. Avoid "Reply All" unless necessary for all recipients

#### 4.6.3. Email Security

- i. Regular password changes required (quarterly minimum)
- ii. Phishing awareness training for all staff annually
- iii. Protocols for handling suspicious emails (Suspicious e-mails to be identified by IT department and inform relevant employee in a timely manner)
- iv. IT Department should provide Guidelines for identifying and reporting security concerns

### 4.7 School Website Management

Should comply with the school website management SOP under below areas

- i. Content update responsibilities and schedule
- ii. Approval process for new content
- iii. Regular review cycle for existing content
- iv. Integration with social media platforms
- v. Analytics review and response process

## 4.8 Learning Management Systems (EduGenie)

Should comply with the LMS SOP of the School under below areas

- i. Platform-specific guidelines for teachers and students
- ii. Content organization standards
- iii. Grading and feedback communication protocols
- iv. Parent access and engagement expectations
- v. Technical support procedures

## 4.9 Other Online Media Platforms

While WhatsApp and Telegram are the primary social media channels, LEEDS may maintain presence on other platforms for specific purposes.

### 4.9.1. Authorized Platforms

- i. **Facebook** : Community engagement and public events
- ii. **Instagram** : Visual storytelling and student achievements
- iii. **LinkedIn** : Professional networking and recruitment
- iv. **YouTube** : Educational content and virtual events
- v. **TikTok** : Short educational video content

### 4.9.2. Content Guidelines - general guidelines for all platforms

#### i. Platform-specific content strategies

Need to publish content suitable to each platform. i.e. while creating a post it needed to be amended according to the platform specific guidelines. E.g. while TikTok uses video shorts and in YouTube can use the long version of the same video.

#### ii. Posting schedule and frequency

Need to schedule posts to reach the maximum target audience. Therefore, need to schedule the posting time accurately based on online usage patterns of the target audience.

#### iii. Approval process for different content types

Need to follow proper approval process before posting any post to social media.

#### iv. Crisis management protocols for social media

Need to follow specific guidelines during hacking of school social media pages

#### v. Engagement with comments and messages

Need to reply to all comments and messages within 24 hours from the post.

## 4.10 Social Media Monitoring and Brand Protection

LEEDS International School acknowledges the significant impact social media can have on institutional reputation. All staff members share responsibility for protecting the school's brand image and responding appropriately to potentially damaging content online.

### 4.10.1 Monitoring and Reporting Negative Content

#### a) Staff Responsibility

- i. All staff members should remain vigilant regarding mentions of LEEDS International School on social media platforms
- ii. If a staff member encounters negative, false, or potentially damaging content about the school, they must report it immediately
- iii. Reporting is required regardless of whether the content was posted by competitors, disgruntled parents, current/former students, or anonymous sources
- iv. Staff should never engage directly with negative content or respond publicly without authorization

#### b) Reporting Procedure

1. **Documentation:** Take screenshots or save links to the concerning content, including:
  - a) The full post/comment and any significant responses
  - b) The name/handle of the person who posted it (if possible)
  - c) The platform and date/time it was posted
  - d) Approximate reach/engagement (views, shares, likes, comments)
2. **Initial Reporting:** Submit the information to your head of the school via the designated channels **i.e. WhatsApp or e-mail**
  - a) Use the subject line: "URGENT: Negative Content Alert"
  - b) Include all documented evidence
  - c) Provide brief context if you have relevant information about the situation
  - d) Indicate the perceived severity (Low, Medium, High, Critical)

### 4.10.2 Response Protocol

Upon receiving reports of potentially damaging content, the following protocol will be implemented:

1. **Initial Assessment** (Within 2 hours of reporting)
  - i. Relevant Leadership members will evaluate the content and potential impact
  - ii. Analyze the Severity of the post published.
  - iii. Key stakeholders notified based on severity level

## **2. Response Strategy Development** (Within 4 hours for High/Critical issues)

- i. Communications team develops appropriate response options
- ii. Obtain Legal consultation if required
- iii. Response approval obtained from Board of Directors depending on severity

## **3. Implementation of Response**

- i. Official responses only delivered by authorized spokespersons
- ii. Response channels selected based on situation (private message, public statement, legal action)
- iii. All responses must align with LEEDS' core values and communication principles

## **4. Follow-up and Monitoring**

- i. Continued tracking of the original content and any subsequent developments
- ii. Documentation of all actions taken and their outcomes
- iii. Assessment of effectiveness and lessons learned
- iv. Regular updates to management until resolution

### **4.10.3 Staff Training and Awareness**

- i. All staff to receive training on social media brand protection as part of orientation
- ii. Annual refresher training on identifying and reporting concerning content
- iii. Regular updates on current social media threats and trends
- iv. Clear guidelines on personal social media usage in relation to school matters

### **4.10.4 Prevention Strategies**

- i. Regular positive content generation to strengthen the school's online presence
- ii. Proactive media relations to establish positive reputation buffers
- iii. Community building with parents and students to create brand advocates
- iv. Regular review of school policies and practices that commonly generate complaints
- v. Monitoring of competitor communications and positioning

## **5. Verbal Communication**

Effective verbal communication remains essential to building strong relationships within the LEEDS community. This section outlines guidelines for various forms of verbal communication.

### **5.1 Telephone Communication**

Telephone communication remains a vital channel for LEEDS International School's interactions with parents, external stakeholders, and among staff members. The way telephone calls are handled often creates the first impression of our institution and directly impacts relationships with our community.

### 5.1.1 Official Phone Usage

- i. Standard greeting to be used by all staff when answering phones: "Thank you for calling LEEDS International School [Branch Name], this is [Name] speaking. How may I assist you today?" or any similar way.
- ii. Call forwarding and voicemail protocols to be followed during unavailable periods
- iii. Response time expectations for returned calls: within 4 working hours for all messages
- iv. Documentation requirements for significant phone conversations including date, time, caller details, and conversation summary - Specially for inquiries and complaints.

### 5.1.2 Telephone Ethics and Etiquette

Professional telephone conduct is essential for maintaining LEEDS International School's reputation. All staff members should adhere to the following ethical standards:

- i. **Professionalism:** Maintain a professional, positive tone throughout all calls regardless of the situation
- ii. **Attentiveness:** Give callers your full attention, avoiding distractions or multitasking during calls
- iii. **Preparedness:** Have necessary information readily available, including school calendars, fee structures, and contact directories
- iv. **Patience:** Practice active listening without interrupting, allowing callers to completely express their concerns
- v. **Accountability:** Take ownership of caller inquiries rather than unnecessarily transferring calls
- vi. **Confidentiality:** Never discuss sensitive student or staff information over the phone in public areas
- vii. **Honesty:** Provide truthful information; if you don't know an answer, acknowledge this and commit to finding the correct information
- viii. **Cultural Sensitivity:** Be mindful of cultural differences in communication styles and expectations
- ix. **Time Management:** Be respectful of both the caller's time and your own while ensuring all necessary information is conveyed

### 5.1.3 Admission Inquiry Handling Protocols

Handling new student inquiries requires particular attention as these calls directly impact enrollment and the school's growth. These conversations create the family's first impression of LEEDS International School and must be managed with exceptional care.

#### a) Call Handling Process

- i. Answer all admission inquiry calls within three rings
- ii. Use a warm, welcoming tone that conveys genuine interest in the prospective student
- iii. **Follow the below mentioned Information Collection Requirements to ensure all essential information is collected**
- iv. Listen carefully for the parent's unstated concerns and priorities
- v. Record all inquiry information to the admissions database immediately (less than an hour)
- vi. Send follow-up information calls within 24 hours of initial inquiry

**b) Information Collection Requirements**

- i. Student's full name, age, and current grade level
- ii. Parent/guardian contact details (phone, email, residential area)
- iii. Current school (if applicable)
- iv. Specific areas of interest (academics, sports, arts)
- v. How they heard about LEEDS International School

**c) Effective Communication Techniques**

- i. Build rapport by using the parent's and child's names throughout the conversation
- ii. Highlight LEEDS' unique educational philosophy and advantages relevant to their specific interests
- iii. Avoid technical language that may confuse parents
- iv. Present fee information clearly and transparently
- v. Address concerns positively without criticizing other educational institutions
- vi. Close with a clear next step and timeline (scheduling of visits, information session, application process)

**d) Challenging Scenarios Guidance**

- i. For questions you cannot answer: "That's an excellent question. I want to make sure you receive accurate information. May I research this and call you back within [specific timeframe]?"
- ii. For concerns about fees: "I understand that education is a significant investment. Let me explain the value our program offers and the various payment options available..."
- iii. For comparisons with other schools: "Each school has its strengths. At LEEDS, our distinctive approach includes [key differentiators]..."

**e) Follow-up Protocol**

- i. Document all conversations in the inquiry tracking system
- ii. Schedule follow-up call within 72 hours if no immediate decision is made
- iii. Send personalized thank-you message after school visits or meetings by parents
- iv. Maintain contact through the decision-making process with valuable information
- v. Conduct conversion analysis to improve inquiry-to-enrollment rates

## **5.2 Staff Mobile Phone Usage Policy**

LEEDS International School recognizes that mobile phones are essential communication tools in modern life, but their use must be properly regulated in an educational environment to maintain professionalism and minimize disruptions to the learning process. This policy aims to balance staff needs with the educational environment's requirements.

**a) Usage Restrictions During Academic Hours**

- i. Academic staff are prohibited from using personal mobile phones during teaching hours and while supervising students.

- ii. Mobile phone usage is permitted only during officially designated break times and free periods when not on supervision duty.
- iii. All staff mobile phones must be kept either on silent mode, vibration mode or low volume setting throughout the school day to prevent disruption.
- iv. Staff should never answer phone calls in the presence of students except in genuine emergency situations.
- v. Staff must refrain from using phones in corridors, classrooms, and other learning areas where students are present when making personal calls

**b) Emergency Exceptions**

- i. In case of emergencies requiring immediate mobile phone use during restricted hours, staff must obtain permission from their Principal/DP/HM or sectional head.
- ii. Staff anticipating urgent calls (e.g., medical emergencies involving family members) should notify the Principal/DP/HM or sectional Head in advance and make appropriate arrangements.
- iii. Emergency communication related to school operations may bypass these restrictions with appropriate authorization.
- iv. Nursing staff, security personnel, and designated emergency responders may be exempt from certain restrictions based on their specific roles.

**c) Professional Etiquette**

- i. Staff must use appropriate, professional ringtones that reflect the educational environment.
- ii. All phones must be kept at low volume settings even during permitted usage times to avoid disturbing colleagues and students.
- iii. Staff should utilize private areas for taking necessary calls during permitted times.
- iv. Extended personal calls should be reserved for break times and kept brief.
- v. Staff should refrain from charging personal mobile devices in classrooms and teaching areas.

**d) Confidentiality and Data Protection**

- i. School-related information should not be stored on personal mobile devices without proper security measures.
- ii. Personal devices used for any school business must have appropriate security measures (password protection, encryption).
- iii. Staff must not share school contact numbers with unauthorized third parties.

**e) Compliance and Consequences**

- i. All staff will receive this policy during orientation and must acknowledge it in writing.
- ii. Random compliance checks may be conducted by school administration.
- iii. Repeated violations will be addressed through the progressive disciplinary process.
- iv. Serious breaches involving student privacy or safety may result in immediate disciplinary action.

#### **f) Staff Responsibility**

- i. Staff are personally responsible for the security of their mobile devices and all other electronic devices on school premises.
- ii. The school is not responsible for damage, loss, or theft of personal devices.
- iii. Staff should report any misuse of mobile phones that violates school policies or student wellbeing.

### **5.3 Face-to-Face Communication**

Face-to-face communication is a cornerstone of LEEDS International School's professional interactions. All staff must uphold the highest standards of professionalism during these interactions.

#### **5.3.1 Professional Conduct Standards**

##### **1. Conversation Management**

- a) Use English as the first communication language for all school related matters.
- b) Maintain a calm, measured speaking voice at all times; avoid speaking loudly even in casual settings
- c) Limit conversations to necessary professional topics in public and working areas
- d) Practice active listening, giving full attention to the speaker without interruption
- e) Focus discussions on constructive, solution-oriented dialogue
- f) Refrain from engaging in unnecessary conversations during working hours
- g) Avoid discussing confidential matters in public spaces or within hearing of unauthorized persons
- h) Never discuss students in front of other students or parents
- i) Use professional language free from colloquialisms, slang, or inappropriate expressions
- j) Resolve disagreements privately and professionally, away from students and parents (if any)
- k) Focus on solutions rather than problems during professional discussions
- l) Respect departmental hierarchies while maintaining open communication channels

### **5.4 Parent-Teacher Meetings**

Parent-teacher meetings are critical opportunities to build trusting relationships with parents. These interactions must be handled with particular care and professionalism.

#### **a) Conducting the Meeting**

- i. Begin with positive observations about the student before addressing any challenges
- ii. Stick to factual, specific observations rather than generalizations about the student
- iii. Focus discussions on student learning and development
- iv. Use clear, jargon-free language accessible to parents from all backgrounds
- v. Be precise and concise in your communications, respecting parents' time
- vi. Provide specific, actionable suggestions for supporting the student at home
- vii. Never discuss other students or make comparisons during parent meetings

#### **b) Professional Boundaries**

- i. Maintain objectivity and avoid personalizing issues or becoming defensive

- ii. Never speak negatively about the school, its policies, or other staff members
- iii. Refrain from offering personal opinions on matters outside your professional expertise
- iv. Respect confidentiality regarding other students and school matters
- v. Avoid making promises or commitments outside your authority to fulfill
- vi. Direct questions beyond your scope to appropriate leadership personnel

**c) Handling Parent Complaints**

- i. Listen attentively to parent concerns without interrupting
- ii. Acknowledge the parent's perspective: "I understand your concern about..."
- iii. Respond factually without becoming defensive or emotional
- iv. Focus on finding solutions rather than assigning blame
- v. Document the complaint and agreed-upon actions following the meeting
- vi. Escalate matters appropriately when they exceed your authority or expertise:

*E.G: "To ensure your concern receives proper attention, I believe our Academic Coordinator would be best positioned to address this. With your permission, I'll arrange that meeting."*

- vii. Follow up on resolved issues to ensure parent satisfaction

## **5.5 External Stakeholder Communication**

### **5.5.1 Community Members (Villagers, PHI, Police, Grama Niladhari, Suppliers etc.)**

- a) Represent LEEDS International School positively in all community interactions
- b) Provide accurate information about school programs and policies
- c) Refer to appropriate leadership for complex or sensitive community concerns
- d) Follow up on community inquiries within established timeframes

### **5.5.2 Official Visitors**

- a) Follow established protocols for greeting and hosting visitors
- b) Ensure visitor experiences reflect the school's values and professionalism
- c) Maintain appropriate confidentiality regarding internal matters
- d) Coordinate visit logistics (e.g.: parking, refreshment etc.) through proper administrative channels
- e) Collect and share feedback from important visits with network leadership and board of directors.

## **6. Crisis Communication**

LEEDS International School Network recognizes the importance of effective, timely, and appropriate communication during crisis situations. This should comply with the school emergency protocol

## **7. Roles and Responsibilities**

Clear definition of communication responsibilities ensures accountability and effective implementation.

### **7.1.Board of Directors**

- a) Approval of communication policy
- b) Participation in Level 1 communication channels
- c) Observation of all level communication tiers
- d) Communication of governance decisions
- e) Strategic direction messaging

### **7.2.Relevant Members of the Network Coordination and Leadership Team**

- a) Overall responsibility for communication strategy
- b) Management of all level communication tiers
- c) Crisis communication leadership
- d) Approval of network-wide communications

### **7.3.School Principals**

- a) Participation and monitoring of Level 3, Level 4 and Level 5 communication within their branches
- b) Regular communication with school community

### **7.4.Group Administrators**

- a) Creation and setup of official WhatsApp and Telegram groups
- b) Maintenance of up-to-date member lists
- c) Enforcement of group guidelines and etiquette
- d) Moderation of discussions when needed
- e) Regular archiving of important information
- f) Reporting of significant issues to appropriate management

### **7.5.Teaching Staff**

- a) Regular classroom and subject-specific communication
- b) Participation in appropriate tier level groups
- c) Parent communication regarding school matters
- d) Adherence to communication standards and timelines

### **7.6.Branch Administrative Staff**

- a) Front-line communication with visitors and callers
- b) Distribution of general information
- c) Management of communication logistics (mail receiving etc.)
- d) Record-keeping of communication.

## **8. Monitoring and Evaluation**

Regular assessment ensures the effectiveness of our communication practices.

### 8.1. Monitoring Methods

- a) Communication audit conducted annually
- b) Group activity analysis for WhatsApp and Telegram
- c) Stakeholder surveys (staff, parent, student)
- d) Social media and website analytics
- e) Response time tracking
- f) Media coverage analysis

### 8.2. Key Performance Indicators

- a) Message delivery and read rates across platforms
- b) Response time compliance with established standards
- c) Stakeholder satisfaction rates
- d) **Communication effectiveness. (No of mistakes by subordinate staff members etc.)**

## 9. Policy Review

This Communication Policy will be reviewed periodically.

## 10. Annexures

### *Annexure 01- Sample messaging Format for WhatsApp and Telegram*

Date: .....

Dear Parents,

Subject: .....

[Write the full content of your message here. Clearly explain the purpose of the communication, important details, any required actions from the parents, and deadlines if applicable. Use polite and professional language throughout.]

Thank you for your continued support and cooperation.

Thank you,

[Your Name]

[Your Designation]

### *Annexure 02 : Sample e-mail signature Format*

**John Smith**

**General Manager – Strategic Management**

Network Leadership and Coordination Department

LEEDS International School

No.7/25, Railway Station Road, Pinwatta,

Panadura, Sri Lanka

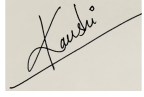
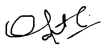
Tel: +94 11 2345678

Mobile: +94 77 1234567

Email: [john.smith@leeds.lk](mailto:john.smith@leeds.lk)

Web: [www.leeds.lk](http://www.leeds.lk) [LEEDS Logo]

## 11.POLICY REVIEW & APPROVAL

| Prepared By                                                                       |                                      | Reviewed By                                                                         |  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|  |                                      |  |  |
| Mr.Binishka Nayananda<br>General Manager Operations                               |                                      | Ms.Kaushalya Illeperuma<br>Coordinating Principal                                   |  |
| Approved By                                                                       | Approved By                          | Approved By                                                                         |  |
|  | <i>Kinithi Jayathissa</i>            |  |  |
| Mr. Thilina Diyagama<br>Director                                                  | Ms. Kinithi Jayathissa<br>Directress | Ms. Malithi Jayathissa<br>Deputy Chairperson                                        |  |

# CERTIFICATE *of* SIGNATURE

REF. NUMBER  
**ZKZW5-YXQJU-DKHX3-FVFSG**

DOCUMENT COMPLETED BY ALL PARTIES ON  
**23 APR 2025 13:40:19 UTC**

## SIGNER

**BINISHKA NAYANANANDA**

EMAIL  
**BINISHKA.GM@LEEDS.LK**

SHARED VIA  
**LINK**

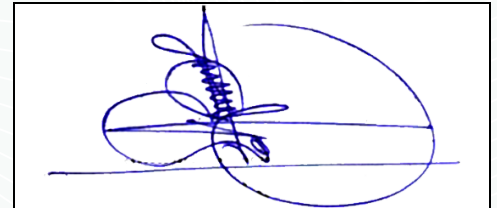
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VIEWED  
**22 APR 2025 12:52:25 UTC**

SIGNED  
**22 APR 2025 12:54:04 UTC**

## SIGNATURE



IP ADDRESS  
**203.189.184.160**

LOCATION  
**COLOMBO, SRI LANKA**

**KINITHI JAYATHISSA**

EMAIL  
**KINITHI@LEEDS.LK**

SHARED VIA  
**LINK**

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VIEWED  
**22 APR 2025 13:08:41 UTC**

SIGNED  
**22 APR 2025 14:12:21 UTC**



IP ADDRESS  
**175.157.154.240**

LOCATION  
**COLOMBO, SRI LANKA**



# CERTIFICATE *of* SIGNATURE

REF. NUMBER  
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**23 APR 2025 13:40:19 UTC**

## SIGNER

**MALITHI JAYATHISSA**

EMAIL  
**MALITHI@LEEDS.LK**

SHARED VIA  
**LINK**

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VIEWED  
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SIGNED  
**22 APR 2025 14:40:28 UTC**

## SIGNATURE



IP ADDRESS  
**93.102.221.110**

LOCATION  
**ALMADA, PORTUGAL**

**KAUSHALYA ILLEPERUMA**

EMAIL  
**KAUSHALYA@LEEDS.LK**

SHARED VIA  
**LINK**

SENT  
**22 APR 2025 12:39:04 UTC**

VIEWED  
**22 APR 2025 13:08:41 UTC**

SIGNED  
**22 APR 2025 17:08:18 UTC**



IP ADDRESS  
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LOCATION  
**COLOMBO, SRI LANKA**



# CERTIFICATE *of* SIGNATURE

REF. NUMBER  
**ZKZW5-YXQJU-DKHX3-FVFSG**

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**23 APR 2025 13:40:19 UTC**

## SIGNER

**THILINA DIYAGAMA**

EMAIL  
**TILINA@LEEDS.LK**

SHARED VIA  
**LINK**

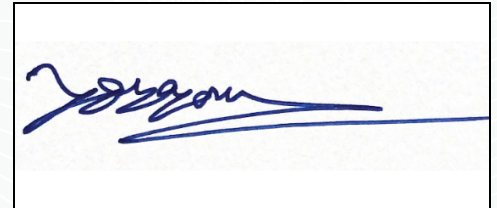
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VIEWED  
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SIGNED  
**23 APR 2025 13:40:19 UTC**

## SIGNATURE



IP ADDRESS  
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LOCATION  
**COLOMBO, SRI LANKA**

